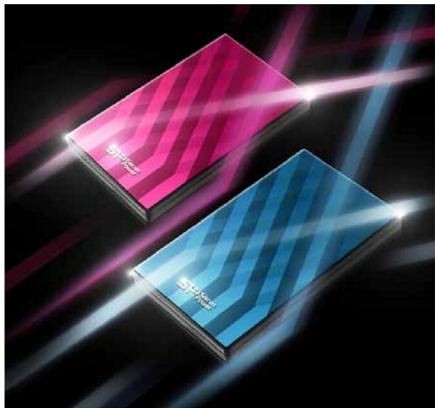


PERSONAL STORAGE DEVICES

With storage requirements going up every day, many of us are investing in personal storage devices or portable storage devices (PSDs) to back up our digital information that is on our computer's storage disk



■ SWATI SHARMA

Personal storage devices (PSDs) have evolved over time and today offer consumers a myriad of choices that help them better organise, manage, share and protect

their digital content. These devices allow you to keep a back up of your important files, documents and other sensitive data. Being portable, these also make information transfer easier to keep you on the go.

With larger capacities, faster transfer speeds and wide options of

PSDs in the market, the buyers have numerous choices, though it makes it complicated for them to make a purchase decision.

This article is a brief guide on various PSD options in the market and deciding factors you should keep in mind while selecting your PSD.

The new-generation PSDs can be broadly classified into following categories:

Optical storage devices. CDs, DVDs, Blu-ray discs

Magnetic hard disk drives (HDDs). Portable hard disk drives

Solid state drives (SSDs). USB Flash drives, portable solid-state drives

Here in this article we are mainly highlighting the portable storage devices such as HDDs and SSDs.

The key difference between optical and magnetic storage media is how computers read and write information on them. The former uses light while the latter uses electromagnetism. It's faster and easier to write data to magnetic storage media. Hard drives can store vast amounts of data and are called random access devices, which means you don't have to search through the entire hard drive to retrieve a piece of data at the end of the disk. However, data stored on optical media tends to be more durable.

SSDs are data storage devices that use solid-state memory to store persis-